

Allen Institute for AI unveils OLMo model for AI development

In a significant stride toward transparency in artificial intelligence, the Allen Institute for AI (AI2) has launched OLMo, a large language model (LLM) challenging the closed-source norm. Founded by Microsoft's Paul Allen in 2014, AI2 aims to provide a genuine alternative to restrictive models.

Unlike its predecessors, OLMo stands out by offering a comprehensive suite of AI development tools to the public. It includes training code, training data, model weights, and evaluation toolkits, accompanied by an Apache 2.0 License. This move distinguishes OLMo from models like OpenAI's GPT-4 and Anthropic's Claude.

This release coincides with a broader trend in open source AI, with other players like Mistral and Meta making strides in performance. OLMo's unique selling point lies in its 'completely open' tools, providing transparency in pretraining data, training code, model weights, and evaluation.

Hanna Hajishirzi, OLMo project lead, emphasised the significance of transparency, stating, "Without access to training data, researchers cannot scientifically understand how a model is working."

Nathan Lambert, an ML scientist at AI2, pointed out OLMo's potential, stating, "OLMo will represent a new type of LLM enabling new approaches to ML research and deployment."

The response from the open source AI community has been positive. Jonathan Frankle, chief scientist at MosaicML and Databricks, called OLMo's release "a giant leap for open science." Meta chief scientist Yann LeCun echoed this sentiment, noting, "Open foundation models have been critical in driving innovation around generative AI."

challenges posed by vulnerabilities like the Log4Shell incident in 2021. It stresses the widespread use of open source code in various applications, emphasising the need for a transparent and collaborative development process.

The report underlines the US government's commitment to open source security through the Open Source Software Security Initiative (OS3I). Efforts in 2023 focused on unifying the federal government's stance, strategising secure approaches, promoting long-term investment, and building trust within the open source community.

A key challenge identified was the lack of best practices in secure development within open source projects. The Cyber Safety Review Board's analysis of Log4Shell noted the absence of coordinated vulnerability response teams in these projects.

The report also highlights the difficulty companies face in identifying vulnerabilities within their open source code, compounded by inadequate contributions back to these projects. The National Science Foundation and the Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) took steps in 2023 to fortify the open source ecosystem, emphasising memory-safe languages and software bill of materials.



A request for information on open source software security was also released, seeking expert opinions. Looking ahead, the OS3I will continue investing in secure software development and engaging the community for policy solutions.

The White House's commitment to securing open source software remains steadfast, with the OS3I poised to enhance the ecosystem's security in 2024 by incorporating insights gathered from the information request.

tea Protocol unveils Incentivised Testnet

The tea Protocol has announced the launch of its long-awaited Incentivised Testnet. This move is designed to seamlessly connect Web2 open source codebases to Web3, providing sustainability and equitable rewards for developers.

Beginning February 21st, this year, open source developers can actively participate in the tea Protocol, earning rewards for their contributions. The wider community, including non-developers, is also encouraged to engage in various incentivised activities on the blockchain.

Max Howell, the founder of tea and creator of Homebrew, stated, "The launch of the Incentivised Testnet for the tea Protocol is a landmark achievement for open source developers and advocates worldwide."